STUMPRIDER · REGULATORY AND STANDARDS REGISTER

StumpRider regulatory and standards register

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	SMR-REG-001	Version	0.1
Status	Draft	Date	2026-10-24
Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stumprider		
Source	docs/07-regulatory.md @ 6afbf98		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-10-24	Amish Chadha	First issue in the kit 1.9.1 upgrade; sources checked 2026-10-25

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No product standard or certification is known to apply to a hand tool for freeing fishing nets in Ghana; that is **to assess** with a local partner, not assumed. The laws that matter most are the ones the tool exists to serve: Ghana's Children's Act, 1998 (Act 560), which makes "going to sea" hazardous work with a minimum age of eighteen, and the Human Trafficking Act, 2005 (Act 694). The tool must never be presented as making children's work on canoes safe or acceptable (UR-011, PR-013). Fishing itself is governed by the Fisheries and Aquaculture Act, 2025 (Act 1146), which has nothing known to say about release tools; whether the Fisheries Commission would promote StumpRider as a safe practice is to assess. Not legal advice; anything marked "to assess" needs a qualified reviewer before any product claim. Method: STANDARDS section 23.

> **Safety:** Nothing in this register makes StumpRider a substitute for life jackets. The Ghana Maritime Authority says life jacket use is mandatory for all water transport; the tool's own rule is that every person on the canoe wears one while a snag is worked.

Table 1. Regulatory and standards register.

#	Standard or regulation	Jurisdiction	What it covers	Applicability to this design	Owner (role)	Status
G1	Children's Act, 1998 (Act 560), section 91: minimum age of eighteen for hazardous work, which "includes going to sea"	Ghana	Child labour and hazardous work	The context the tool serves. The tool and every document state that it is never a reason to keep children on boats; distribution only with child-protection partners (UR-011, SMR-DDR-001 D9)	Partner liaison (child-protection NGO)	Applies (to the context; met by design in the wording and the distribution rule)
G2	Human Trafficking Act, 2005 (Act 694)	Ghana	Trafficking and intermediaries; consent is no defence for children	As G1; the README and PRB state the context factually and name no boat owner or community	Partner liaison	Applies (to the context)
G3	ILO Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No. 182) and Minimum Age Convention, 1973 (No. 138), as reflected in Ghana's law	International	Hazardous work of children	As G1	Partner liaison	Applies (to the context)
G4	Fisheries and Aquaculture Act, 2025 (Act 1146)	Ghana	Fisheries management, inland management plans, gear and vessel licensing, the Fisheries Commission	A release tool is not fishing gear in the usual sense; whether any gear or safe-practice provision touches it, and whether the Commission can promote it, is not known	Partner liaison with the Fisheries Commission (Volta zone)	To assess
G5	Ghana Maritime Authority safety rules on inland waterways, including mandatory life jackets and its Code of Operation for boat operators	Ghana	Safety of water transport on the Volta Lake	The tool's operating rules (life jackets, kneel, cut rather than capsize, the 7 m rule) sit inside these; no approval of a hand tool is known to be needed	Partner liaison	To assess
G6	ISO 12402 series, personal flotation devices	International	Life jackets and buoyancy aids	The float winder floats the ring and cord only; StumpRider is not a flotation device and must never be presented as one	Design lead	Does not apply

#	Standard or regulation	Jurisdiction	What it covers	Applicability to this design	Owner (role)	Status
G7	ISO 1461, hot dip galvanized coatings on fabricated iron and steel articles	International	Coating thickness and testing	Called up in the BOM for the steel parts (line 18) as the galvaniser's standard where one is used; zinc-rich paint is the fallback	Design lead	Applies (as specification, to confirm with the galvaniser)
G8	ISO 4017, ISO 4032, ISO 7089 and ISO 2341 fasteners and clevis pins	International	Bolt, nut, washer and clevis pin dimensions	Used for the bought fasteners and in the model (`.kit/cad_parts.py`)	Design lead	Met by design
G9	Patent US3464138A, device for releasing a snagged fishing lure (expired)	United States	Sliding ring and weight on a line	Public prior art; the design keeps to a plain split ring and publishes its own shear pin value (SMR-PRC-001, patent design-arounds). Not legal advice	Design lead	Met by design
G10	Product liability for an open design used on the water	Ghana and wherever it is built	Responsibility if a tool built from the drawings is used and someone is hurt	Published as an open engineering reference, not certified equipment; the warnings travel with every document and kit (PR-013). The legal position is not known	Maintainer, with legal advice	To assess
G11	Open hardware licences: CERN-OHL-S-2.0 (hardware), MIT (software), REUSE	International	Licensing	Applies to the repository	Maintainer	Met by design

Status: to assess, applies, does not apply, met by design, certification needed later.

Sources

- Ghana, *Children's Act, 1998* (Act 560), section 91, https://www.ecoi.net/en/file/local/1158191/1504_1217427520_children-s-act.pdf, accessed 2026-10-25.
- US Department of Labor, Bureau of International Labor Affairs, *Ghana's Laws and Regulations on Child Labor, WFCL and Education* (Acts 560, 651, 694 and 778; minimum ages), https://dol.gov/sites/dolgov/files/ILAB/Ghana%27s%20Laws%20and%20Regulations%20on%20Child%20Labor%2C%20WFCL%20and%20Education.pdf, accessed 2026-10-25.
- UNEP Law and Environment Assistance Platform, *Fisheries and Aquaculture Act, 2025 (Act 1146)*, https://leap.unep.org/en/countries/gh/national-legislation/fisheries-and-aquaculture-act-2025-act-1146, accessed 2026-10-25; Ghana News Agency, "President Mahama assents to the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025",

https://gna.org.gh/2025/08/president-mahama-assents-to-the-fisheries-and-aquaculture-bill-2025/, accessed 2026-10-25.

- *Daily Graphic*, "3 co-wives, 5 children perish in canoe disaster: Maritime Authority insists life jackets use mandatory for all water transport", 11 April 2026, https://www.graphic.com.gh/news/general-news/ghana-news-3-co-wives-5-children-perish-in-canoe-disaster-maritime-authority-insists-life-jackets-use-mandatory-for-all-water-transport.html, accessed 2026-10-25.
- Google Patents, US3464138A, https://patents.google.com/patent/US3464138 (cited in SMR-PRB-001).
- ISO 12402, ISO 1461, ISO 4017, ISO 4032, ISO 7089, ISO 2341: titles as published by ISO; scope as used here, not checked clause by clause.